PW Skills - Learner Code of Conduct (Offline Centres)

Document Owner: Academic Operations (Offline)
Applies To: All learners enrolled in PW Skills offline programs across all centres
Effective From: 1st Jan 2026
Version: 1.0
Review Cycle: Every 6 months or after any major incident/policy update

CODE OF CONDUCT

Learners enrolled in the skill development and job-readiness programs offered by the PW SKILLS and residing on the campus are strongly advised to adhere to the guidelines set forth under this Code of Conduct ("Code"). It is hereby clarified and reaffirmed that the Institute exclusively provides skill-based training and career-readiness programs and does not offer any formal degree, diploma, or academic qualification of any kind.

1. Purpose

PW Skills is committed to providing a safe, respectful, inclusive, and effective learning environment. This Code of Conduct sets clear expectations for learner behaviour, protects learners and staff, and ensures smooth operations across centres.

2. Scope

This policy applies:

- On centre premises (Server rooms, classrooms, labs, reception, corridors, washrooms, parking areas where applicable).
- During centre activities off-site (industry visits, events, workshops).
- In official PW Skills communication spaces related to offline courses (WhatsApp/Telegram groups, LMS discussion, email threads).
- During assessments and placement activities conducted or proctored by PW Skills.

3. INSTITUTE'S RULES AND REGULATIONS

- All learners must carry their Identity Card at all times and produce it before the security personnel or Institute authorities whenever required.
- No outsider shall be permitted entry onto the campus premises without proper identity verification and registration of the purpose of the visit.

- Smoking, consumption, possession, or use of alcoholic beverages, tobacco products, narcotics, or any prohibited substances is strictly forbidden within the Institute and hostel premises.
- Learners are expected to attend all scheduled classes, doubt-solving sessions, assessments, workshops, and other academic activities regularly. Any planned absence should be informed in advance and approved by the Institute wherever possible. In case of medical leave exceeding four days, the Institute may require submission of a valid medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner.
- Learners shall maintain proper dress code, personal hygiene, and present themselves in a neat and decent manner while attending classes or being present on campus.
- Learners shall behave with dignity, mutual respect, and courtesy toward fellow learners, faculty members, staff, and Institute authorities.
- Any act causing damage to the Institute infrastructure, classrooms, hostel facilities, furniture, equipment, walls, or other property including writing on walls, sticking posters, or defacing property is strictly prohibited. Any cost incurred due to such damage shall be recovered from the concerned learner(s).
- No learner shall leave the classroom or training session without the permission of the faculty or Assistant Faculty before the session concludes. Learners arriving late may enter the session only with the permission of the faculty member.
- If any individual wishes to meet a learner during an ongoing session, prior permission must be obtained from the concerned faculty member or Institute authority.
- Loitering within the campus during class hours or remaining unnecessarily on campus beyond permitted hours is not allowed.
- No meetings, gatherings, events, or entertainment activities shall be organized on the Institute premises without prior approval from the Institute authorities.
- Any lost or found item must be immediately reported to the Institute office or concerned authorities.
- Learners are required to maintain a minimum cumulative attendance of 75% to remain compliant with the Institute's academic and participation requirements.

4. Learner Rights (What PW Skills commits to)

Every learner has the right to:

1. A safe environment free from harassment, discrimination, bullying, and intimidation.
2. Fair assessment and transparent academic requirements.
3. Privacy of personal data within reasonable operational needs and legal compliance.
4. Access to support for grievances, safety issues, and reasonable accommodations.

5. Learner Responsibilities (Minimum Expectations)

Each learner is expected to:

- Follow the instructions and guidance provided by the Assistant Faculties (AFs), trainers, staff members, and Institute authorities regarding academic activities, classroom discipline, safety protocols, and centre operations.
- Treat fellow learners Assistant Faculties (AFs), staff members, visitors, and surrounding community members with respect, professionalism, and courtesy at all times.
- Use and maintain the Institute's infrastructure, classrooms, equipment, and learning resources responsibly and refrain from any misuse or damage to Institute property.
- Maintain academic integrity, discipline, and professional conduct throughout the duration of the program, including during classes, assessments, doubt-solving sessions, workshops, and all Institute-related activities.
- Contribute toward maintaining a positive, collaborative, and distraction-free learning environment within the campus and classrooms.
- Adhere to the attendance requirements, schedules, and operational guidelines communicated by the Institute from time to time.

6. Professional Conduct in the Classroom

To maintain a productive, professional, and respectful learning environment, all learners are expected to adhere to the following classroom conduct guidelines:

Expected Behaviour

- Learners should arrive prepared for every class or session with the necessary learning materials, including laptops (where required), chargers, notebooks, and any required software or tools.
- Mobile phones must be kept on silent mode during sessions. In case of urgent calls, learners are expected to step outside the classroom without disturbing the ongoing session.
- Learners are encouraged to actively participate in discussions, activities, and doubt-solving sessions in a respectful and constructive manner without causing disruption to others.
- All communication within the classroom must be professional and respectful, including during discussions, debates, or disagreements with Assistant Faculties (AFs), staff members, or fellow learners.

Prohibited Behaviour

The following actions are strictly prohibited within the classroom and campus premises:

- Use of shouting, abusive language, insulting remarks, threatening behaviour, body shaming, discriminatory comments, or offensive slurs.
- Mocking, ridiculing, or discriminating against any individual on the basis of background, gender, religion, accent, disability, language, personal appearance, or economic status.
- Repeatedly interrupting Assistant Faculty or sessions, engaging in continuous side conversations, creating unnecessary distractions, or disturbing the learning environment despite warnings.
- Any form of bullying, harassment, intimidation, social exclusion, group targeting, or behaviour that negatively impacts the well-being or participation of others.

Disciplinary Measures

In situations where a learner repeatedly disrupts the classroom environment or fails to comply with the expected standards of conduct, the Institute staff or faculty members may take appropriate corrective measures, including changing seating arrangements, assigning a temporary cool-off break, restricting participation for a particular session, or removing the learner from the ongoing class/session if deemed necessary.

7. Academic Integrity and Ethical Conduct

The Institute places high importance on honesty, originality, and ethical conduct in all academic and project-related activities. All learners are expected to maintain academic integrity throughout the duration of the program.

Learners Must Not:

- Copy, cheat, or use unauthorized materials during tests, assignments, assessments, or evaluations, including the use of hidden notes or sharing answers with others.
- Submit another person’s work, assignments, projects, code, or materials as their own, including copied online resources, repositories, or GitHub projects without proper attribution, authorization, or understanding.
- Engage in or promote paid assignment/project completion services, including paying someone else to complete work on their behalf or offering such services to others.
- Impersonate another learner or request any individual to appear, attend, submit work, or participate in assessments on their behalf.
- Manipulate attendance records, assessment records, proxy sign-ins, or any Institute-related academic documentation.

Use of AI and Digital Tools

The Institute recognizes and supports the responsible use of modern learning tools, including Artificial Intelligence (AI) platforms and productivity tools, for educational and learning assistance purposes. However, learners are expected to use such tools ethically and responsibly.

- If AI tools or external assistance are used in assignments, projects, or submissions, learners may be required to disclose such usage as per the instructions provided by the Assistant Faculty (AF), or Institute authorities.
- Learners must possess a clear understanding of the submitted work and should be able to independently explain, present, or defend their work during discussions, viva sessions, interviews, or verification processes.
- The use of AI-generated responses, unauthorized tools, or external assistance during closed-book examinations, proctored tests, or restricted assessments shall be treated as academic misconduct and cheating.

Verification and Disciplinary Action

If a learner submits a project, assignment, or assessment but is unable to adequately explain or demonstrate understanding of the submitted work, the Institute may require the learner to undergo additional verification, viva assessments, project rebuilding, or resubmission processes.

Repeated violations, misrepresentation of work, or acts of academic dishonesty may result in disciplinary action as deemed appropriate by the Institute.

8. Device Usage, Internet Access, Recording, and Content Protection

To maintain a focused, secure, and professional learning environment, all learners are expected to use digital devices and Institute resources responsibly.

Acceptable Usage

- Laptops, mobile phones, tablets, and internet access provided or used during sessions must be utilized strictly for learning, classroom activities, assessments, research, and other academic purposes related to the program.

Prohibited Activities

The following activities are strictly prohibited during classes, workshops, doubt-solving sessions, assessments, or while present on Institute premises:

- Using devices for gaming, gambling, streaming entertainment, social media misuse, or any activity that disrupts the learning environment or distracts others.
- Recording audio, video, or taking photographs of classes, Assistant Faculties (AFs), learners, classroom sessions, or Institute activities without prior written permission from the Institute authorities.
- Capturing, sharing, or distributing photographs or copies of examination papers, assessments, internal evaluation rubrics, confidential documents, or restricted academic materials.
- Sharing, selling, reproducing, uploading, distributing, or publicly circulating any Institute-owned content or learning materials including slides, class recordings, notes, question banks, assignments, projects, lab materials, or internal resources unless explicitly authorized by the Institute in writing.

Disciplinary and Legal Action

Unauthorized recording, misuse, reproduction, or distribution of Institute content, confidential information, or classroom materials may result in immediate disciplinary action. In serious cases, the Institute reserves the right to initiate legal proceedings or take any other action deemed appropriate under applicable laws and policies.

9. Payments, Refunds, and Official Communication Channels

- All program fees, payments, and related transactions must be made only through the official payment channels authorized by the Institute or PW Skills.
- Learners must not provide cash payments, personal UPI transfers, or any unofficial payments directly to staff members, Assistant Faculties (AFs), or any other individuals for purposes including fees, certifications, placements, batch changes, or transfers.
- Requests related to refunds, fee deferrals, cancellations, or financial adjustments shall be processed strictly in accordance with the official refund and payment policies of the Institute.
- Any form of harassment, intimidation, abusive behaviour, threats, or misconduct directed toward staff members or Institute authorities regarding payments, refunds, or financial matters shall be treated as a serious disciplinary violation.

Important Note: Threatening behaviour, abusive communication, or attempts to pressure staff members regarding financial matters may result in immediate suspension or disciplinary action pending further review and resolution.

10. Centre Transfers, Batch Changes, and Cross-Centre Discipline

- Requests for batch changes, centre transfers, or schedule modifications shall only be considered through the officially approved process and will be subject to factors including seat availability, prerequisites, fee policies, operational feasibility, and academic scheduling.
- Learners are not permitted to attend sessions, classes, or activities of another batch or centre without prior approval from the Institute authorities.
- Serious acts of misconduct, indiscipline, academic dishonesty, harassment, or policy violations committed at any Institute or PW Skills centre may result in disciplinary restrictions applicable across all centres and programs, including suspension, assessment restrictions, or permanent removal in severe cases.

11. Communication Standards and Responsible Conduct

Official Groups and Communication Platforms

All learners are expected to maintain professional and respectful communication across official groups, discussion forums, calls, emails, and other communication channels associated with the Institute.

The following actions are strictly prohibited:

- Use of abusive, offensive, discriminatory, or disrespectful language.
- Spamming, unauthorized promotions, advertising, or unrelated commercial activities.
- Political campaigning, religious campaigning, or activities that may disturb the learning environment or create conflict among learners.
- Sharing personal information of others, including phone numbers, addresses, private details, or screenshots of private conversations, without consent.
- Contacting Assistant Faculties (AFs), staff members, or Institute authorities at unreasonable hours except in genuine emergency situations.

12. Social Media Conduct

Learners may share their learning experiences, achievements, or educational journey responsibly; however, the following activities are prohibited:

- Recording or publishing photographs, videos, or personal information of other learners, or staff members without consent.

- Sharing confidential academic materials, internal content, restricted information, or Institute-owned resources without authorization.
- Posting false, defamatory, misleading, or harmful statements against any learner, staff member, trainer, or the Institute.
- Encouraging harassment, online abuse, trolling, or targeted misconduct against individuals or groups.

13. Reporting Issues and Grievance Redressal

The Institute encourages learners to responsibly report concerns related to:

- Harassment, bullying, discrimination, or misconduct.
- Safety hazards or security concerns.
- Academic integrity violations or unethical practices.
- Fraudulent activities related to payments, certifications, placements, or Institute operations.

Reporting Channels

- Centre Coordinator: Assistant Faculties (AF's)

Non-Retaliation Policy

The Institute strictly prohibits retaliation, victimization, or unfair treatment against any learner or individual who reports concerns, complaints, or misconduct in good faith.

14. Disciplinary Process and Corrective Actions

Depending upon the severity, frequency, or nature of the violation, the Institute may take one or more of the following disciplinary actions:

- Verbal or informal warning with documented observation.
- Written warning along with a corrective or improvement plan.
- Behavioral agreement or conduct contract specifying conditions for continuation.
- Temporary suspension from classes, batches, assessments, or campus facilities.
- Removal from the batch, program, or Institute.
- Restriction or ban from one or multiple PW Skills centres in severe cases.

Fair Process and Learner Rights

The Institute is committed to maintaining a fair and transparent disciplinary process. Learners against whom complaints or allegations are raised shall generally:

- Be informed of the concerns or allegations made against them, unless immediate safety or security risks require urgent action.
- Be provided an opportunity to explain their perspective and submit relevant information or evidence.
- Receive documented communication regarding the outcome of the disciplinary review process.

Appeals Process

Learners may submit an appeal against disciplinary action within **7 working days** of the decision to the designated Appeals Committee or official appeals email address, particularly in cases involving:

- New or additional evidence.
- Procedural errors during the disciplinary process.
- Concerns regarding disproportionate disciplinary action.

15. Sanctions Matrix (Quick Reference)

See the table below for a typical response by severity. Actual action may vary based on facts, impact, and repeated behaviour.

Level	**Examples**	**Typical Actions**
Level 1 (Minor)	Phone misuse, minor disruption, first-time lateness pattern	Warning, seat change, temporary removal from class session
Level 2 (Moderate)	Repeated disruption, disrespect, violating group rules, minor cheating attempt	Written warning, counselling, suspension (1-7 days), re-assessment conditions
Level 3 (Severe)	Harassment, threats, violence, major cheating, impersonation, theft, illegal substances, recording without consent	Immediate suspension/removal, ban, and authorities involved when required